

Question:

A mental health volunteer is interviewing locals as part of a community outreach program. A 46-year-old man discloses that he has felt sad for as long as he can remember. He feels as though his life is cursed and if something terrible can happen to him, it usually will. He has difficulty making decisions and feels hopeless. He also feels that he has had worsening suicidal ideations, guilt from past problems, energy, and concentration over the past 2 weeks. He is otherwise getting enough sleep and able to hold a job. Which of the following statement best describes this patient's condition?

Answer Choices:

- A. The patient is at risk for double depression.
- B. The patient may have symptoms of mania or psychosis.
- C. The patient is likely to show anhedonia.
- D. The patient likely has paranoid personality disorder.

Reasoning + Answer:

<think> The patient's symptoms include long-term sadness, feelings of hopelessness, worsening suicidal ideations, guilt, and difficulty making decisions. These symptoms have also been present for the past two weeks. The patient's history of feeling that bad things always happen to him suggests a pessimistic outlook. The patient is able to work and sleep, indicating that these basic functions are intact. However, the combination of long-term sadness, recent worsening of symptoms, difficulty in decision making, and suicidal ideations strongly suggest a depressive disorder, particularly a major depressive episode. Anhedonia is common in depression and refers to a diminished ability to feel pleasure. Mania or psychosis is not suggested by the information provided. The patient's difficulty in making decisions and symptoms of depression are more consistent with a depressive disorder rather than a personality disorder, which would typically be characterized by more enduring, maladaptive patterns of behavior and thinking.

</think>

<answer> C. The patient is likely to show anhedonia. </answer>

